

ENDLESS CREATIVITY

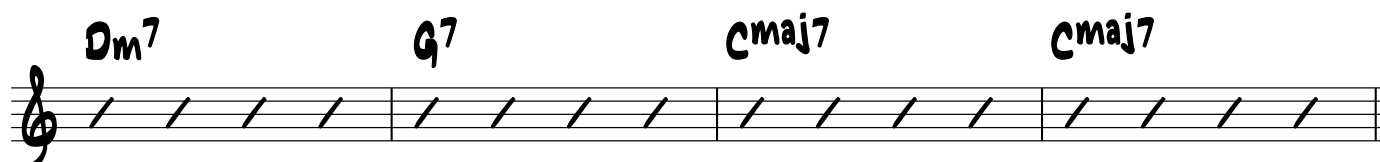
FROM DIGGING DEEPER VIDEO #174

When we listen to our heroes improvise, it seems that their creativity is endless. We imagine it is impossible to say where their inspiration comes from, and the ideas seem innumerable. How in the world can we even begin to understand what these jazz immortals are doing, let alone begin to do something similar ourselves?

The answer - you just need 10 things. Probably less.

What is the difference between an amazing player and you? One way to think about it is that they have "10 ways" to approach a given musical situation (a set of chords, a tonality, a tempo, a style). You might have two or three. Develop *10 approaches* to a given musical situation, and you are well on your way to endless creativity.

#1 - "ii - V - I" progression in C



How many ways do you have to approach the harmonic situation above, when improvising a solo? Here is a very incomplete list, in no particular order. You likely have others to add.

- 1) Play diatonically in the key of C major.
- 2) Use chord tones in each measure.
- 3) Incorporate lower neighbor tones.
- 4) Use enclosures.
- 5) Use a Charlie Parker lick.
- 6) Tritone sub the V chord.
- 7) Tritone sub the ii chord.
- 8) Use triad pairs.
- 9) Use the Coltrane Minor Pentatonic sound on each chord.
- 10) Play free.

Of course, each of these 10 approaches has numerous branches of their own. It gets pretty infinite pretty quickly. But, this DOES give us a clear, simple and true path forward to understanding what our job is, and how to proceed in our practice each and every day.